What Is GitHub?

An entry-level tour, with real screenshots

Where does your code live?

Git

A tool that remembers every version of your files

Git and GitHub Are Not the Same

Git

On your computer

VS

GitHub

On the web

Repository

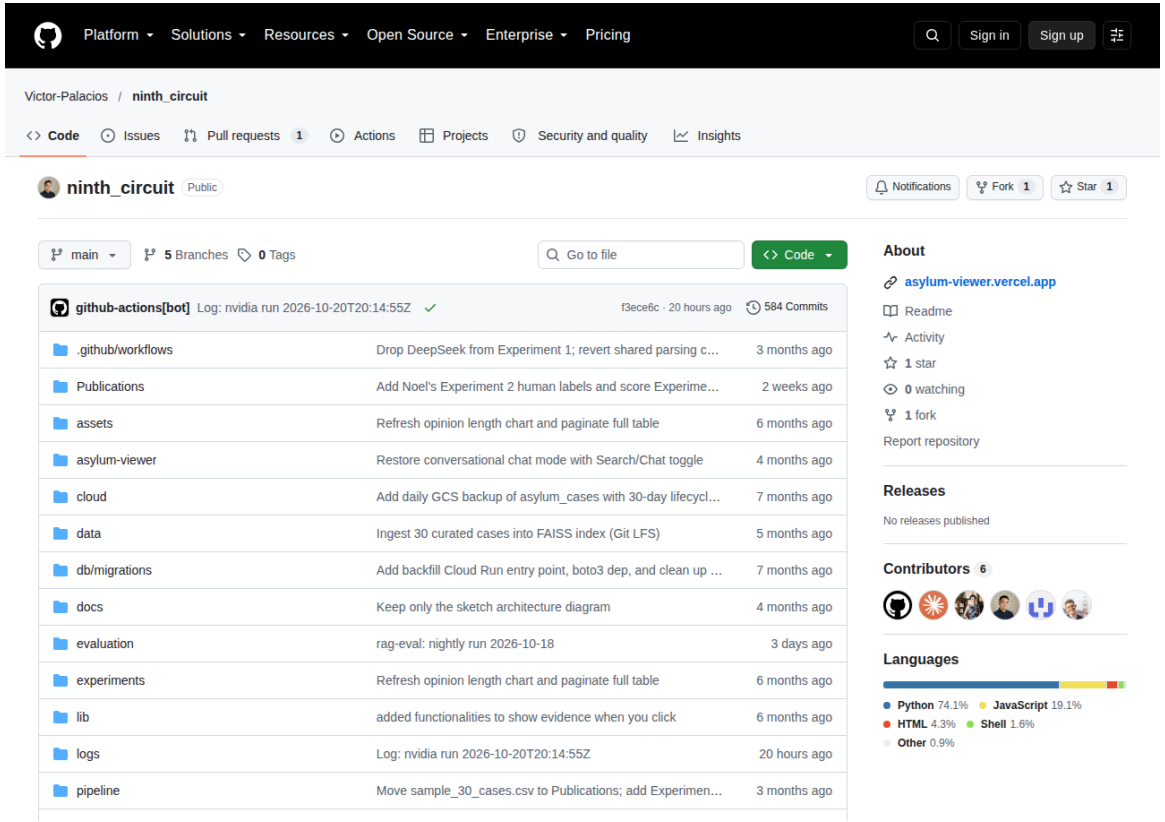
One project's folder, with its whole history

A Real Repository

This is ninth_circuit

Folders and files

584 commits of history



[Source]

Where Things Are on the Page

Tab	What it holds
Code	The files themselves
Issues	To-dos and bug reports
Pull requests	Changes waiting for review
Actions	Jobs that run by themselves

Commit

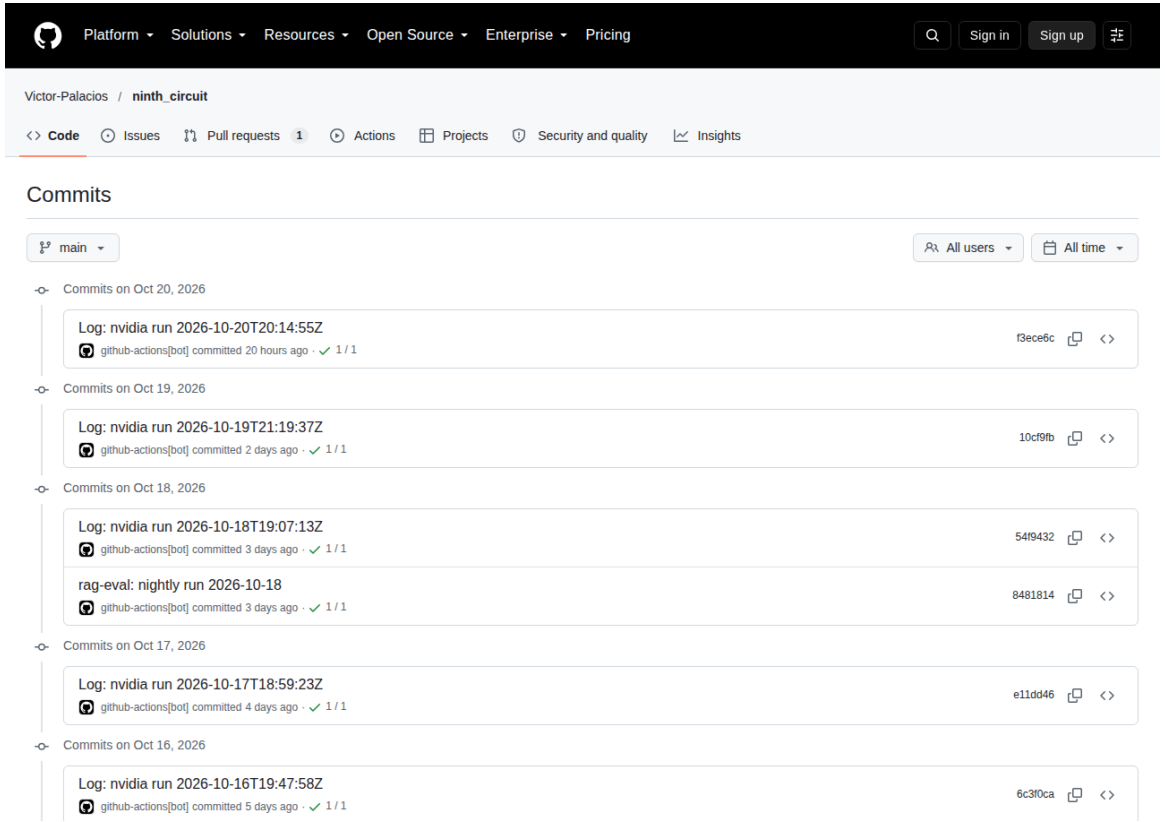
A saved snapshot, with a note saying why

History You Can Read

Newest at the top

Who, when, and why

Any one can be restored



Source

The Basic Loop

01 Edit

Change files on your computer

02 Commit

Save a snapshot with a note

03 Push

Send it up to GitHub

Branch

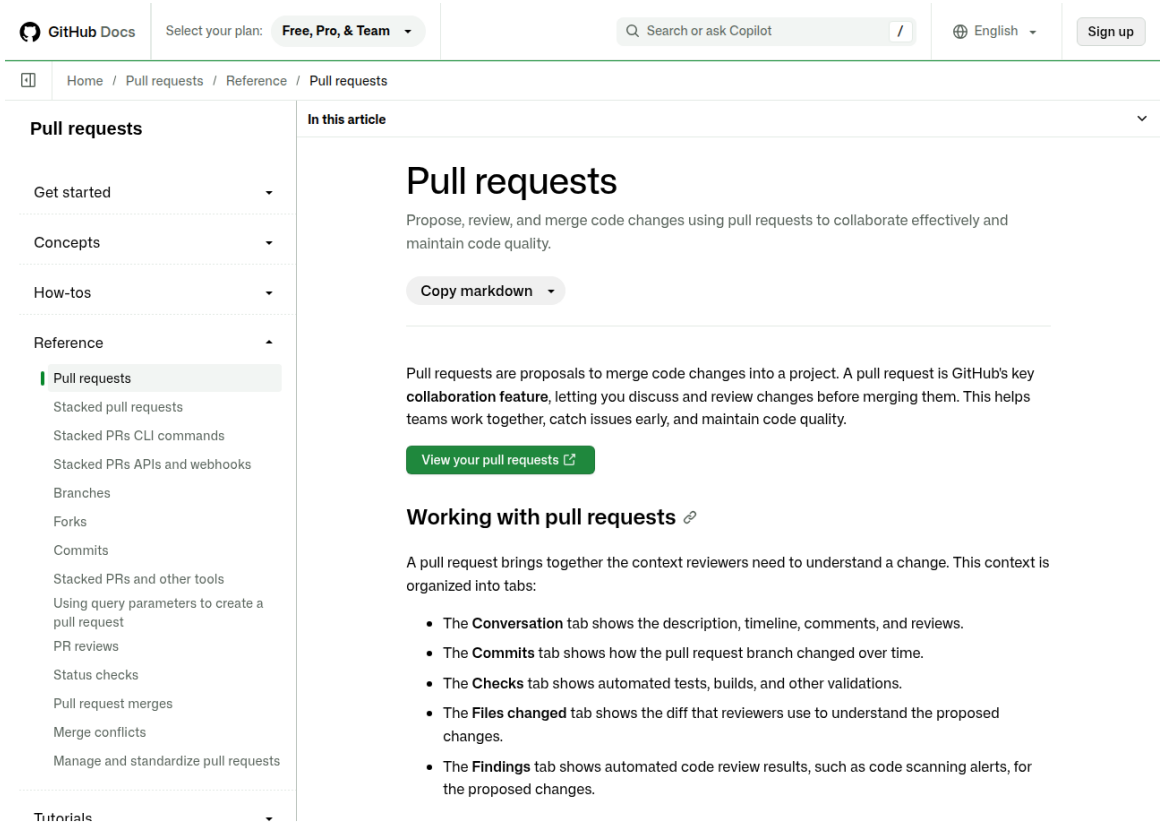
A separate line of work that leaves main alone

Proposing a Change

Show what you changed

Others review it

Then it is merged



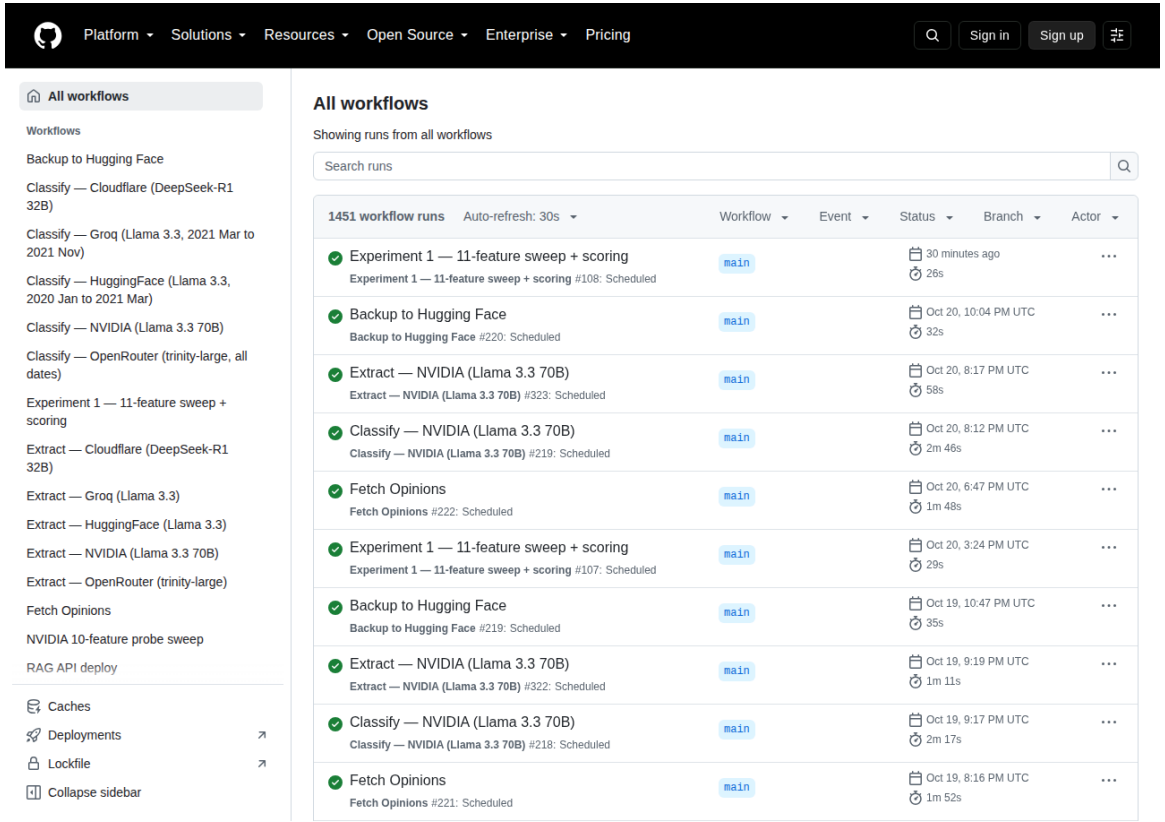
Source

Work That Runs Itself

Jobs on a schedule

1,451 runs so far

No laptop required



Source

What Actions Are Good For

Running your tests on every change

A job every night, like fetching data

Publishing a website

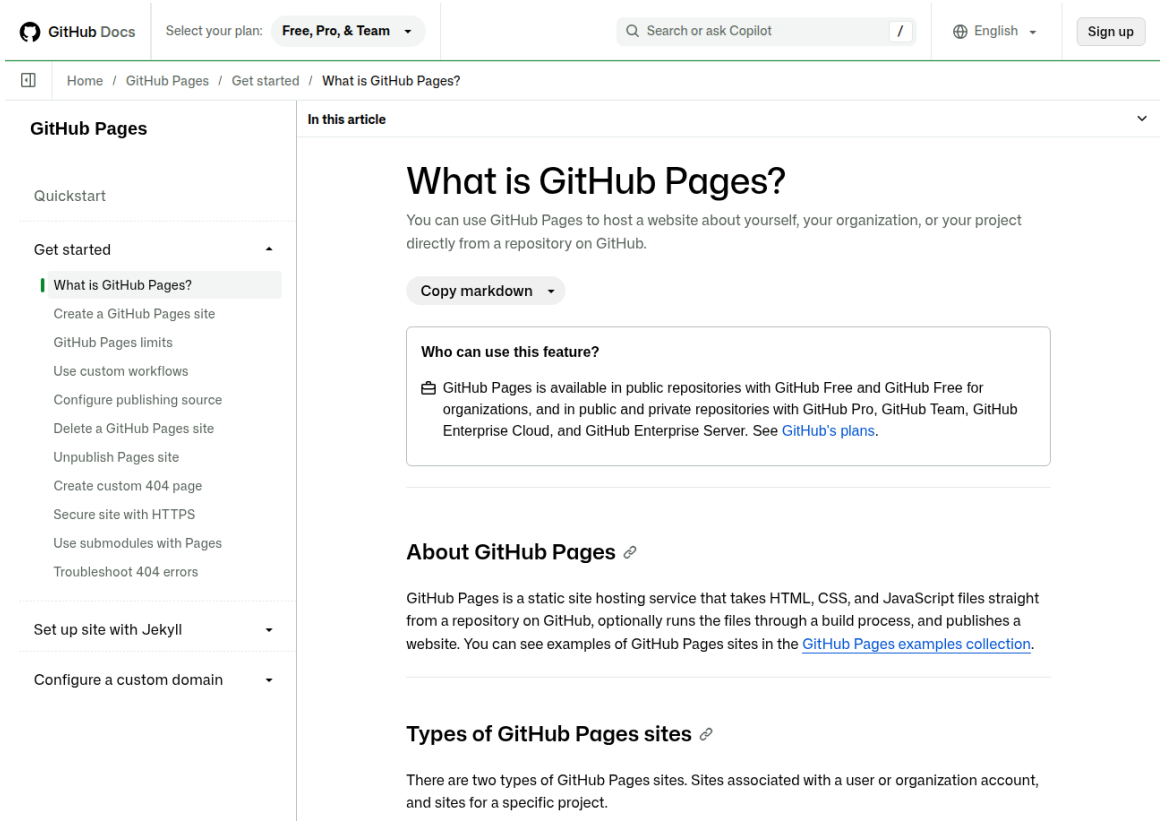
Backing up your results

A Free Website From a Repo

HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Served from your repo

A public web address



Source

Public or Private

Public: anyone can read it

Private: only people you invite

Both keep the full history

So never commit a password

Your First Ten Minutes

01 Make an account

It is free

02 Create a repository

Tick the box to add a README

03 Edit the README

Commit it, and look at History

Screenshots, Captured 21 Oct 2026

Screenshot	Captured from
Repository	…/ninth_circuit
Commit history	…/ninth_circuit/commits
Actions	…/ninth_circuit/actions
Pull requests	docs.github.com
Pages	docs.github.com

What will you put in yours?